



reza hashemi &lt;mrhashemi2000@gmail.com&gt;

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**International Journal of Astrobiology - Decision on IJA-2026-0085**

9 messages

**International Journal of Astrobiology** <onbehalf@manuscriptcentral.com>

Wed, Jul 29, 2026 at 7:08 PM

Reply-To: frances.westall@cnrs.fr

To: mrhashemi2000@gmail.com

Cc: ijaeditorial@cambridge.org

29-Jul-2026

Dear Dr. Hashemi:

I am sorry to inform you that your manuscript # IJA-2026-0085 entitled "Environmental Selection of Thymine over Uracil in Prebiotic Chemical Evolution: Insights from a Kinetic Monte Carlo Model" has not been accepted for publication in International Journal of Astrobiology.

The comments of the reviewer(s) which led to this decision can be found at the bottom of this letter.

Thank you for considering the International Journal of Astrobiology for the publication of your research. I hope the outcome of this specific submission will not discourage you from the submission of future manuscripts.

Sincerely,

Dr. Frances Westall

Associate Editor, International Journal of Astrobiology

[frances.westall@cnrs.fr](mailto:frances.westall@cnrs.fr)

Reviewer(s)' Comments to Author:

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**Reza Hashemi** <mrhashemi2000@gmail.com>

Wed, Jul 29, 2026 at 8:38 PM

To: frances.westall@cnrs.fr

Cc: ijaeditorial@cambridge.org

Dear Dr. Westall

Reviewer(s)' Comments to Author:

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No Reviewer(s)' Comments to Author: !

Sincerely,

**Dr. Reza Hashemi****Creator of Matter World Hypothesis**

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**IJA Editorial** <ijaeditorial@cambridge.org>

Wed, Jul 29, 2026 at 9:09 PM

To: Reza Hashemi &lt;mrhashemi2000@gmail.com&gt;, "frances.westall@cnrs.fr" &lt;frances.westall@cnrs.fr&gt;

Dear Author,

I apologize for the confusion.

The message you received is a default system template, which states that reviewers' comments are attached. However, in your case, the Associate Editor decided not to send the manuscript out for peer review, and it was therefore desk rejected.

As a result, there are no reviewer comments associated with this decision.

Thank you for your understanding. If you need any further clarification, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Best wishes.

Mrs. Maria Estrada-Flórez  
Editorial Office  
International Journal of Astrobiology

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**De:** Reza Hashemi <[mrhashemi2000@gmail.com](mailto:mrhashemi2000@gmail.com)>  
**Enviado:** miércoles, 29 de julio de 2026 17:08  
**Para:** [frances.westall@cnrs.fr](mailto:frances.westall@cnrs.fr) <[frances.westall@cnrs.fr](mailto:frances.westall@cnrs.fr)>  
**Cc:** IJA Editorial <[ijaeditorial@cambridge.org](mailto:ijaeditorial@cambridge.org)>  
**Asunto:** Re: International Journal of Astrobiology - Decision on IJA-2026-0085

You don't often get email from [mrhashemi2000@gmail.com](mailto:mrhashemi2000@gmail.com). [Learn why this is important](#)

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**Reza Hashemi** <[mrhashemi2000@gmail.com](mailto:mrhashemi2000@gmail.com)>  
To: IJA Editorial <[ijaeditorial@cambridge.org](mailto:ijaeditorial@cambridge.org)>  
Cc: "[frances.westall@cnrs.fr](mailto:frances.westall@cnrs.fr)" <[frances.westall@cnrs.fr](mailto:frances.westall@cnrs.fr)>

Wed, Jul 29, 2026 at 9:53 PM

**Subject: Regarding the Decision and Process for Manuscript IJA-2026-0085**

Dear Mrs. Estrada-Flórez,

Thank you for your prompt response and for clarifying the confusion regarding the decision letter.

While I appreciate the clarification, I must express my professional disappointment regarding the editorial process. Receiving a system template that explicitly claims reviewer comments are attached, only to later discover it was a "default template" for a desk rejection, is highly misleading and contrary to the transparency expected from a prestigious journal like the International Journal of Astrobiology.

Moreover, a desk rejection, while within the editor's prerogative, should typically be accompanied by a brief scientific justification—such as the manuscript being "out of scope" or "lacking novelty." In this case, the absence of any specific reasoning leaves the author in the dark regarding why the work was deemed unsuitable for peer review.

This is particularly regrettable because the manuscript presents the "Matter World Hypothesis," a paradigm shift that challenges the conventional RNA World model. By utilizing a rigorous Kinetic Monte Carlo simulation (UPDSF v4.4) and validated prebiotic chemical parameters, the work provides a quantitative explanation for the environmental selection of Thymine over Uracil—a fundamental question in the origins of life.

I believe that such a provocative and evidence-based hypothesis deserves, at the very least, a brief explanation as to why it did not meet the criteria for peer review.

Best wishes.

**Dr. Reza Hashemi**  
**Creator of Matter World Hypothesis**

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**Reza Hashemi** <mrhashemi2000@gmail.com>  
To: IJA Editorial <ijaeditorial@cambridge.org>  
Cc: "frances.westall@cnrs.fr" <frances.westall@cnrs.fr>

Thu, Jul 30, 2026 at 8:21 AM

**Subject:** Clarification Request – Manuscript IJA-2026-0085

Dear Mrs. Estrada-Flórez and Dr. Westall,

I hope this message finds you well.

I am writing in relation to manuscript IJA-2026-0085, "Environmental Selection of Thymine over Uracil in Prebiotic Chemical Evolution: Insights from a Kinetic Monte Carlo Model."

In the decision letter and the subsequent clarification, it was explained that the manuscript was desk-rejected and was not sent out for peer review.

I noticed, however, that the ScholarOne system displayed the status "Awaiting Reviewer Selection" for a considerable period before the final decision was issued. I am attaching screenshot of the system status for your reference.

I would be grateful if you could kindly clarify how this status relates to the editorial process that was followed in this case.

Thank you very much for your time and assistance.

Sincerely,  
**Dr. Reza Hashemi**

**Creator of Matter World Hypothesis**

ORCID: 0009-0002-0645-5180  
[mrhashemi2000@gmail.com](mailto:mrhashemi2000@gmail.com)

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156K

**WESTALL Frances** <frances.westall@cnrs.fr>  
To: Reza Hashemi <mrhashemi2000@gmail.com>  
Cc: IJA Editorial <ijaeditorial@cambridge.org>

Thu, Jul 30, 2026 at 10:47 AM

Dear Dr. Hashemi,  
The reason for the delay in dealing with your manuscript is that it was only recently put on my action list - and I have just had an operation therefore I myself am a bit slow.

Yours sincerely  
Frances Westall

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**De:** "Reza Hashemi" <[mrhashemi2000@gmail.com](mailto:mrhashemi2000@gmail.com)>  
**À:** "IJA Editorial" <[ijaeditorial@cambridge.org](mailto:ijaeditorial@cambridge.org)>  
**Cc:** "frances westall" <[frances.westall@cnrs.fr](mailto:frances.westall@cnrs.fr)>  
**Envoyé:** Jeudi 30 Juillet 2026 06:51:40  
**Objet:** Re: International Journal of Astrobiology - Decision on IJA-2026-0085

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**Reza Hashemi** <[mrhashemi2000@gmail.com](mailto:mrhashemi2000@gmail.com)>  
To: WESTALL Frances <[frances.westall@cnrs.fr](mailto:frances.westall@cnrs.fr)>  
Cc: IJA Editorial <[ijaeditorial@cambridge.org](mailto:ijaeditorial@cambridge.org)>

Thu, Jul 30, 2026 at 12:54 PM

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**Subject:** Request for Clarification Regarding the Editorial Handling of Manuscript IJA-2026-0085

**To:** IJA Editorial Office (Mrs. Maria Estrada-Flórez)  
**Cc:** Dr. Frances Westall

**Dear Dr. Rocco Mancinelli,**

**Editor**

**International Journal of Astrobiology**

I hope this message finds you well.

I am writing to respectfully request your clarification regarding the editorial handling of my manuscript **IJA-2026-0085**, entitled:

**"Environmental Selection of Thymine over Uracil in Prebiotic Chemical Evolution: Insights from a Kinetic Monte Carlo Model."**

This letter is **not** an appeal against the editorial decision itself. I fully recognize and respect the Editor's discretion to decline a manuscript without external peer review. My concern instead relates to the **consistency, transparency, and accuracy of the documented editorial process**.

Following the decision, I contacted the Editorial Office after observing several inconsistencies in the official record.

The decision letter explicitly stated:

*"The comments of the reviewer(s) which led to this decision can be found at the bottom of this letter."*

However, no reviewer comments were attached.

Subsequently, the Editorial Office informed me that this wording resulted from a **default system template** and that the manuscript had **not been sent for external peer review**.

While I appreciate this clarification, it leaves an important procedural inconsistency unresolved.

For a considerable period before the final decision, the ScholarOne system displayed the status:

**Awaiting Reviewer Selection**

To better understand the editorial workflow, I respectfully asked how this status related to a manuscript that was ultimately described as never having entered peer review.

Dr.r Frances Westall kindly replied that the delay occurred because the manuscript had only recently appeared on her action list and that she had recently undergone surgery. I sincerely appreciate her response and wish her a complete recovery.

However, although this explains the delay in processing, it does not explain the meaning of the ScholarOne status itself.

Consequently, the official record currently contains several documented inconsistencies:

- the decision letter states that reviewer comments formed the basis of the decision;
- the Editorial Office subsequently confirmed that no peer review had taken place;
- ScholarOne displayed "**Awaiting Reviewer Selection**" for an extended period;
- the explanation subsequently provided addressed only the processing delay and not the workflow status;
- no editorial explanation was provided for the desk rejection.

Individually, each of these issues might have a simple explanation. Collectively, however, they create uncertainty regarding the documented editorial history of the manuscript.

I therefore respectfully request clarification of the following questions:

1. What did the ScholarOne status "**Awaiting Reviewer Selection**" specifically represent in the editorial history of manuscript IJA-2026-0085?
2. Was the manuscript ever assigned for reviewer selection?
3. Were any reviewers identified, considered, or invited before the editorial decision was reached?
4. Why did the official decision letter refer to reviewer comments if no peer review had taken place?
5. What was the principal editorial basis for deciding that the manuscript should not proceed to external review?

I respectfully emphasize that my purpose is not to dispute the editorial outcome, but to ensure that the official record of the editorial process is transparent, internally consistent, and accurately documented.

Given the importance of transparency and procedural integrity in scholarly publishing, I would greatly appreciate your clarification.

I would also be grateful if the Editorial Office could include this correspondence in the official record of manuscript **IJA-2026-0085**.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

**Yours sincerely,**

**Dr. Seyed Mohammad Reza Hashemi (Reza Hashemi)**

Independent Researcher  
Creator of the Matter World Hypothesis  
ORCID: 0009-0002-0645-5180  
mrhashemi2000@gmail.com

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**WESTALL Frances** <frances.westall@cnrs.fr>  
To: Reza Hashemi <mrhashemi2000@gmail.com>  
Cc: IJA Editorial <ijaeditorial@cambridge.org>

Fri, Jul 31, 2026 at 10:07 AM

Dear all,

I did write comments in the coment box as to why I rejected the manuscript but apparently they did not appear in the letter sent to the author. I think we need to correct this editorial issue so that future authors do not have the same problem.

**Yours sincerely**  
**Frances Westall**

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**De:** "Reza Hashemi" <mrhashemi2000@gmail.com>  
**À:** "WESTALL Frances" <frances.westall@cnrs.fr>  
**Cc:** "IJA Editorial" <ijaeditorial@cambridge.org>  
**Envoyé:** Jeudi 30 Juillet 2026 11:24:08

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**Reza Hashemi** <mrhashemi2000@gmail.com>  
To: WESTALL Frances <frances.westall@cnrs.fr>  
Cc: IJA Editorial <ijaeditorial@cambridge.org>

Fri, Jul 31, 2026 at 5:05 PM

**Subject:** Request for Your Personal Review of the Editorial Record – Manuscript IJA-2026-0085

**Dear Dr. Rocco Mancinelli,**

I am writing to you personally because, despite several exchanges with the Editorial Office and the Associate Editor, the documentary record concerning manuscript **IJA-2026-0085** remains internally inconsistent and raises legitimate questions regarding the editorial process followed in this case.

I wish to emphasize that **this is not an appeal against the editorial decision itself**. I fully recognize the Editor's authority to decline a manuscript without external peer review.

My concern is different.

It concerns the accuracy and consistency of the official editorial record.

The documentary history now contains several statements that cannot easily be reconciled.

First, the official decision letter explicitly states:

*"The comments of the reviewer(s) which led to this decision can be found at the bottom of this letter."*

Yet the section titled **"Reviewer(s)' Comments to Author"** is completely empty.

After I reported this inconsistency, the Editorial Office informed me that this wording was merely a **default system template** and that **no peer review had taken place** because the manuscript had been desk rejected.

Subsequently, however, Dr. Westall wrote:

*"I did write comments in the comment box as to why I rejected the manuscript, but apparently they did not appear in the letter sent to the author."*

This introduces a new explanation that differs from the one previously provided by the Editorial Office.

The difficulty is not simply that comments failed to appear.

The official decision letter does **not** contain a generic "Comments" section.

It contains only a section explicitly entitled:

#### **Reviewer(s)' Comments to Author**

If no reviewers existed, as the Editorial Office confirmed, then it is unclear what "comment box" Dr. Westall was referring to, why those comments were expected to appear in a section designated for reviewer comments, and why the decision letter itself explicitly referred to reviewer comments.

In addition, the ScholarOne workflow displayed the status **"Awaiting Reviewer Selection"** for a considerable period before the rejection decision.

When I requested clarification regarding this specific workflow status, the response explained only the reason for the processing delay and did not address the meaning of that status.

Accordingly, the official record now consists of:

- a decision letter referring to reviewer comments;
- confirmation that no reviewer comments existed;
- a subsequent statement that editorial comments had in fact been entered into a comment box;
- an unexplained "Awaiting Reviewer Selection" workflow status;
- and multiple explanations that remain difficult to reconcile.

These are not minor editorial details.

They concern the integrity, transparency, and internal consistency of the editorial record maintained by the Journal.

For that reason, I respectfully request your personal review of this case.

Specifically, I would appreciate clarification of the following:

1. Which specific ScholarOne comment field did Dr. Westall refer to in her email?
2. Is that field intended to populate the section entitled **"Reviewer(s)' Comments to Author"** in the decision letter?
3. If not, why did the official decision letter direct the author to reviewer comments that did not exist?
4. What did the ScholarOne status **"Awaiting Reviewer Selection"** represent in the editorial history of this manuscript?

5. Can the Journal confirm that the official editorial record accurately reflects every stage of the manuscript's handling?

As a journal published by Cambridge University Press, I believe the **accuracy of the editorial record** is of fundamental importance.

I therefore respectfully request your personal clarification of these issues.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours sincerely,

**Dr. Seyed Mohammad Reza Hashemi (Reza Hashemi)**

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